

Westhampton Finance Committee Meeting
September 15, 2015

Meeting opened at 7:05 PM

Present: Chair, Ellice Gonzalez, Celeste Whiting, Thomas Cleary, Chevy Seney, Ed Zawacki, Jackie Brodeur, Joe Pipczynski, Aniko Giordano

Ellice opened meeting speaking about the FY16 budget. Explained the By-law that outlines the duties and responsibilities of the Finance Committee (FC). She explained how past town meeting votes were taken when the articles were changed after the Finance Committee had voted on them. She asked the committee for direction on the Special Town Meeting (STM) scheduled for October 5, 2015. She outlined steps that the Finance Committee could take.

- 1) Suggested that the Finance Committee send a letter to the Board of Selectmen (BOS) inviting them to a FC meeting to discuss the timing of information needed from the BOS to the FC relevant to a Town Meeting as required by the By-law.

- 2) Suggested the FC attend a meeting of the BOS to explain the necessity of following the By-law.

It was determined that the FC would ask to be placed on the agenda for the BOS for their meeting on Monday September 21, 2015.

Discussed the draft articles we received at our last meeting. Because we were told that there was an urgency for STM due to the need for budget finalization and the tanker truck grant, after much discussion decided to provisionally vote on articles for the STM on October 5, 2015

Article 1: voted, 7 yes, 0 opposed, 1 abstention

Article 2: voted 6 yes, 0 opposed, 2 abstentions

Article 3: voted 1 yes, 1 opposed, 6 abstentions

Approved minutes from meeting of August 4, 2015

Discussed the reports on salary raises including the misuse of the term COLA, encumbered funds and specific line items that may be potentially deleted in the budget such as school committee and moderator salaries. All of these reports will be used to guide the planning for the FY17 budget.

Set next meeting on October 20, 2015 at 7pm.

Meeting adjourned 8:50pm

Respectfully submitted

Joseph I Pipczynski